

OFFICIAL REGULATIONS

Little Tiny Docs

International Short Documentary Film Festival

1. Festival Overview

Little Tiny Docs – International Short Documentary Film Festival is organized University of Maia (UMAIA, Portugal), through the Department of Communication Sciences and Information Technologies, by the Bachelor's Degrees in Multimedia Art and Multimedia Communication Technologies, in partnership with the CIAC – Centro de Investigação em Artes e Comunicação (UMAIA Hub).

The first edition of the festival will take place during the second half of October 2026 at Universidade da Maia, Portugal.

The 2026 thematic focus is: “Crossings”

The theme is intentionally open and may be interpreted through social, cultural, political, geographical, emotional, technological, poetic, speculative, or experimental perspectives.

Little Tiny Docs aims to promote short-form documentary cinema as a space for experimentation, critical reflection, and contemporary audiovisual expression.

2. Eligibility

2.1. The festival is open to participants from all countries.

2.2. Any individual or collective (represented by 1 person) may submit one (1) documentary film.

2.3. Submitted films must:

- have a maximum duration of 5 minutes, excluding initial and end credits;
- have been completed within the last three (3) years;
- meet the minimum technical requirement of HD resolution.

2.4. Previously screened, published, or academically produced works are eligible.

2.5. Documentary films created partially or entirely with Artificial Intelligence tools are accepted, provided participants hold the necessary rights for all included materials.

2.6. Participants under 18 years old must provide parental or legal guardian authorization.

3. Accepted Formats and Language

3.1. All documentary formats and approaches are accepted, including experimental, hybrid, animated, observational, essayistic, and expanded documentary forms.

3.2. Films may be submitted in any language.

3.3. Films not spoken in English must include English subtitles.

4. Submission Process

4.1. Submissions must be made exclusively through the official Google Form provided by the festival.

4.2. Participants must provide:

- film title;
- synopsis;
- duration;
- resolution specifications;
- director/author biography;
- technical credits;
- three (3) still images from the film;
- Vimeo or YouTube screening link ¹.

4.3. Submission deadline:
September 30, 2026.

4.4. Selected films will be announced on:
October 15, 2026.

4.5. Submission is free of charge.

5. Selection Process

5.1. A maximum of forty (40) films will be officially selected for screening.

5.2. The selection committee will consist of academics and film/media professionals.

5.3. Evaluation criteria include:

- relevance to the festival theme;
- originality and artistic approach;
- documentary and narrative quality;
- cinematic language;
- technical execution.

5.4. The selection committee's decisions are final and not subject to appeal.

¹ In case of being selected, the participant will have to submit a copy of the film (with embedded subtitles) for screening purposes.

6. Awards

The festival's juri will attribute:

- Best Documentary Award
- Four Honorable Mentions

Awards consist exclusively of official certificates of recognition.

The Jury is composed of academics and professional.

The Juri's decisions are final and not subject for appeal.

7. Copyright and Screening Rights

7.1. Participants retain full copyright ownership of their works.

7.2. By submitting a film, participants authorize the festival to:

- publicly screen the work during the festival;
- use excerpts, trailers, stills, titles, and promotional materials for communication, press, educational, and promotional purposes related to the festival.

7.3. The festival does not claim any commercial rights over submitted works.

8. Participant Responsibilities

8.1. Participants are solely responsible for obtaining all necessary permissions, licenses, and rights related to:

- image rights;
- soundtrack/music rights;
- archival materials;
- third-party content;
- AI-generated materials.

8.2. The organization assumes no legal responsibility regarding copyright infringement or unauthorized use of protected materials.

9. Disqualification

The organization reserves the right to disqualify submissions that:

- contain false or misleading information;
- fail to meet technical requirements;
- constitute plagiarism;
- promote discriminatory, hateful, or illegal content;
- violate applicable copyright laws.

10. Data Protection (GDPR)

10.1. Personal data submitted to the festival will be used exclusively for purposes directly related to festival organization, communication, screening, and archival documentation.

10.2. The festival commits to complying with applicable General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) standards and related international data protection principles.

11. Force Majeure

The organization reserves the right to modify dates, schedules, formats, or cancel the festival due to unforeseen circumstances, force majeure events, or situations beyond its control.

12. Acceptance of the Regulations

Submitting a film implies full acceptance of the present regulations and all decisions made by the festival organization and jury.

13. Contact

Official contact: littletinydocs@gmail.com